BBarters
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# Savoir & Connaître

Similitudes et Différences

Savoir and Connaître are both translated as 'to know' in English. However, both describe a different degree of knowledge.

## Savoir - To know

### Present Tense Conjugations

| | |
|---|---|
| Je sais | Nous savons |
| Tu sais | Vous savez |
| Il/Elle/On sait | Ils/Elles savent |

## Connaître - To know

| | |
|---|---|
| Je connais | Nous connaissons |
| Tu connais | Vous connaissez |
| Il/Elle/On connaît | Ils/Elles connaissent |

## Savoir + Noun / Relative Pronoun

**To Know Facts / Information**

| Français | English |
|---|---|
| Elle sait la vérité. | She knows the truth. |
| Ils savent que le magasin ferme à vingt heures. | They know that the shop closes at 8pm. |
| Nous savons bien la vraie raison. | We know the real reason well. |

## Savoir + Verb

**To Know How To Do Something / Skill set**

| Français | English |
|---|---|
| Il sait réagir aux situations difficiles. | He knows how to react in difficult situations. |
| Je ne sais pas nager. | I don't know how to swim. |
| Nous savons parler français. | We know how to speak French. |
| Elle sait convaincre quelqu'un. | She knows how to convince someone. |

To sum up, 'savoir' can mean "to be instructed in something, to be capable of an activity of which one has acquired practice, to have something in one's memory to be able to repeat it," and "to be informed of something."

## Connaître + Quelqu'un

**To Know Someone (Having met that person)**

| Français | English |
|---|---|
| Je connais une femme qui est polyglotte. | I know a woman who is multilingual. |
| Anne connaît la personne qui peut vous aider. | Anne  knows a person who can help you. |
| Elles connaissent très bien la famille de ton petit ami. | They know the family of your boyfriend very well. |

## Connaître + Place

Having visited a place before & thus, being familiar with that place.

| Français | English |
|---|---|
| Émily ne connaît pas Paris. | Emily has never been to Paris. |
| Je connais le Louvre. | I have visited the Louvre. |

## Connaître

**To meet Success/ Failure/ to experience**

| Français | English |
|---|---|
| Son nouveau roman connaît un grand succès. | His new novel is a great success. |
| Le film connaît une sortie limitée au Royaume-Uni. | The film received a limited release in the UK. |
| L'économie connaît une croissance rapide. | The economy is growing rapidly. |

## Savoir V/S Connaître

| Français | English |
|---|---|
| Je **sais** que vous **connaissez** mon cousin. | I know that you have met my cousin. |
| Je **connais** une fille qui **sait** parler italien. | I know a girl who knows how to speak Italian. |
| Elle **sait** que son frère **connaît** le voleur. | She knows that her brother knows (personally) the thief. |

**Note -** Furthermore, 'connaître' is to have knowledge of the existence of a thing, to identify it, to hold it to be real. Whereas 'savoir' is to have a thorough knowledge of a thing that results from learning, to have in the mind a set of ideas and images constituting knowledge about that object of thought. Generally, 'savoir' implies a deeper and more rational knowledge than 'connaître.'

# Connaître Or Savoir

**To Know By Heart / To Memorise -** We can use either the verb 'Savoir' or 'Connaîre' to know something or to memorise something by heart.

| Français | English |
|---|---|
| Elle connaît cette chanson par cœur.<br>Elle sait cette chanson par cœur. | She knows this song by heart. |
| Connais-tu ton discours par cœur ?<br>Sais-tu ton discours par cœur ? | Do you know your speech by heart ? |

## To Be Familiar with a Thing or a Subject

Use **"connaître"** when referring to **being familiar with a concept, book, work of art, or subject**.

✅ **Examples:**

- **Je connais ce livre.** → *I know (am familiar with) this book.*
- **Elle connaît bien l'histoire de France.** → *She knows French history well.*
- **Nous connaissons cette théorie.** → *We are familiar with this theory.*

**Final Tip:** If you can replace "to know" with **"to be familiar with"** in English, use **"connaître."** If it means **"to know a fact"** or **"to know how to do something,"** use **"savoir."**